Military Leadership Competencies

Quick briefing

Distinguish leading, developing, and achieving by the purpose of the leader's action.

Know the facts

Leadership · Influencing people through purpose, direction, and motivation to accomplish the mission and improve the organization.

Leading · Lead others and by example, communicate for shared understanding, and extend influence within its practical limits.

Developing · Create a positive environment, prepare yourself for future challenges, and build others' capabilities.

Achieving · Set direction and priorities, plan and execute, and monitor performance against mission and longer-term objectives.

Attributes and competencies · Attributes describe qualities a leader brings to the task. Competencies describe abilities applied through action.

Understand the reasoning

A leader can meet today's deadline and still leave the unit dependent on one experienced person. Developing others addresses that future gap.

The same activity can serve several competencies. Classify it by its main purpose, such as listening to align the team or coaching to build lasting capability.

Philippine Army classroom exercise

A Philippine Army company is preparing a classroom demonstration. One experienced soldier can finish every equipment handover quickly, but the junior team leaders have yet to perform a full handover themselves.

Decision · How can the company complete this demonstration and build capacity for the next one?

Worked analysis · Set a completion standard and protect the demonstration deadline. Have the experienced soldier model one handover, then assign a junior leader to run the next one with observed feedback. Review errors before allowing an independent handover. This develops the team while keeping the current task on track.

How to practice

1 · State the immediate result and the capability the team should retain afterward.

2 · Give each participant a role and confirm the standard through a brief backbrief.

3 · Demonstrate the task, then have a learner perform it while an experienced soldier observes.

4 · Review the result against the standard and assign a follow-up practice opportunity for any recurring gap.

Check yourself

Which competency includes preparing yourself and developing others? · Developing.

Why is monitoring performance part of achieving? · It lets the leader compare progress with the desired result and adjust priorities or execution.

Course source

Military Leadership Competencies (Leading, Developing, and Achieving)